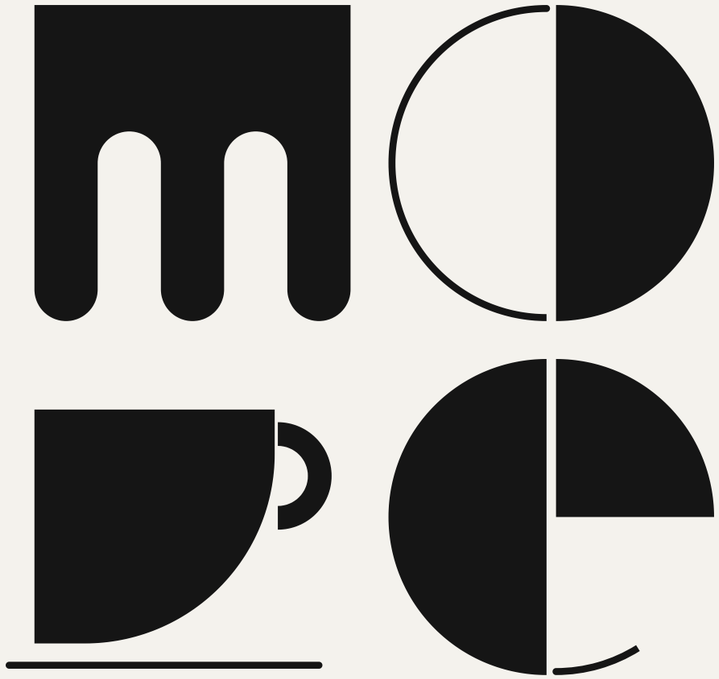


BRAND GUIDELINES

MODE

Coffee concentrate, in single-serve sachets. The mark, the colours, the type, and how all of it goes onto a sachet, a carton and a screen.

VERSION 1.0 · OCTOBER 2026

CONTENTS

01 The idea
02 The mark
03 Construction
04 The four letters
05 Clear space and size
06 Small sizes
07 Colour versions
08 Misuse
09 Colour
10 Contrast
11 Typography
12 The modes
13 Sachet
14 Sachet in use
15 Carton
16 Carton dieline
17 Mailer
18 Tumbler
19 Social
20 Web
21 Brand film
22 Files

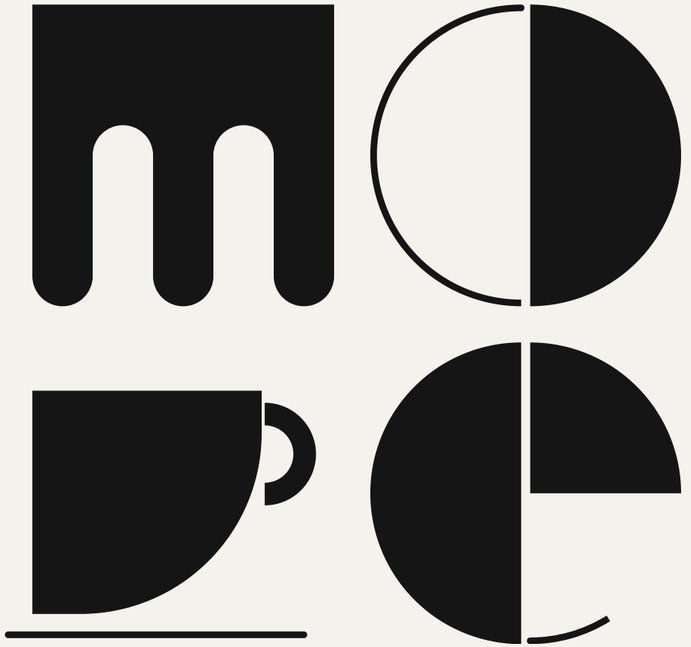
THE IDEA

Every letter of MODE is a coffee.

The mark borrows its grammar from Albert Hollenstein's L'Echoppe monogram: a square, a half-disc and a quarter-disc, all cut from one radius, separated by a thin cut, and finished by hairlines of the same radius. Nothing else is allowed in.

With that kit, each letter of MODE becomes a coffee and still reads as its letter. The m is a square of coffee that drips. The o is half poured, from the side. The D is a cup on its saucer. The e is Hollenstein's own e, left open: the one letter that isn't a drink.

Stacked MO over DE, the four make a compact block that sits in a corner of a sachet the way a seal sits on a letter. The mark never changes: the five modes (Wake, Active, Zen, Vital, Calm) are named on the pack, never drawn into the letters.





PRIMARY · CARBON ON PAPER

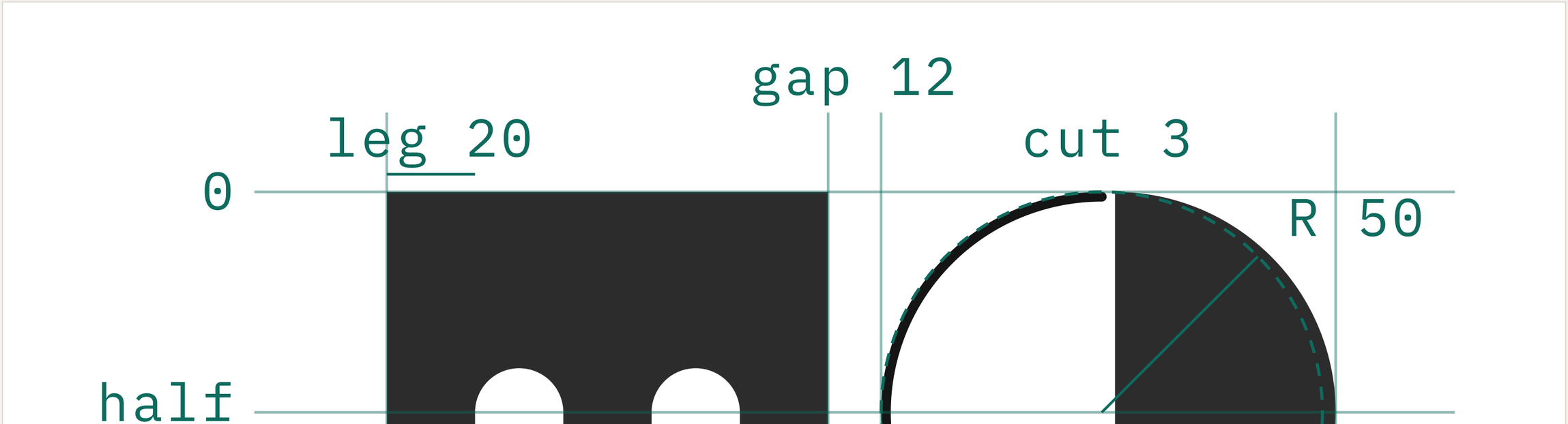


CONSTRUCTION

One radius, one cut, one hairline.

Each letter is 100 units tall. Everything else follows from that.

Radius	50: half a letter. Every curve in the mark uses it, except the cup's belly (60) and handle (17).
Cut	3 between solids that meet: the o's halves, the e's half-disc and quarter.
Hairline	2.2 with round ends; 6 in the small-size cut.
Gaps	12 between the columns and between the rows.
Legs	20 wide, ending in half-disc drops. The m's arches stop exactly halfway.
Overall	224 × 212. The saucer overhangs the left edge by 9 on purpose; align to the m, not the saucer.

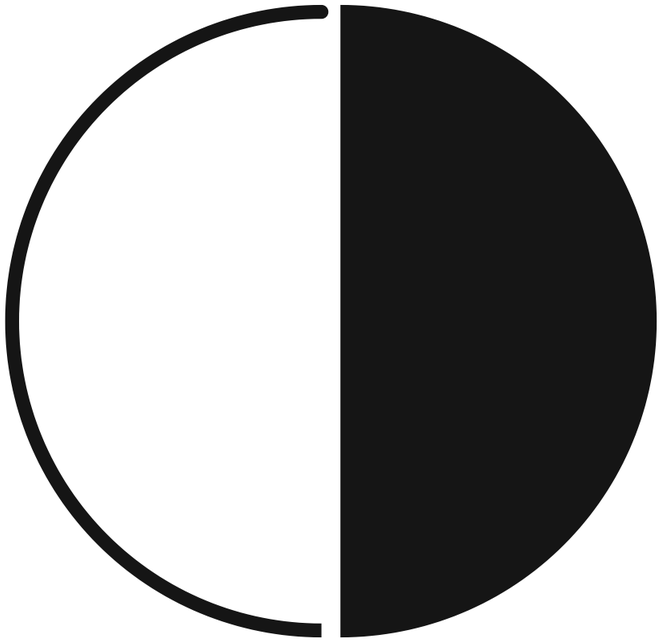


THE FOUR LETTERS

Each still reads as its letter.



A square of coffee that drips.



Half poured, from the side.

CLEAR SPACE AND SIZE

Two drips of air on every side.

Keep a clear space of 40 units around the mark: twice the width of one of the m's legs. Nothing else (type, edges, folds, other marks) goes inside it. The files ending in `-clearspace` include it.

Print	12 mm wide minimum. Under 15 mm, use the small-size cut.
Screen	40 px wide minimum for the full mark; 32 px and below, the small-size cut.
Tiny	Below 24 px, use the monogram (the m alone).



SMALL SIZES

Heavier hairlines when it gets small.





Monogram

The m alone: the top-left block of the mark. For favicons, embossing and anything under 24 px.



Favicon

16 px uses the monogram; 32 and 48 px use the small-size cut.



COLOUR VERSIONS

One colour at a time.

CARBON ON PAPER

CARBON ON OAT

PAPER ON CARBON

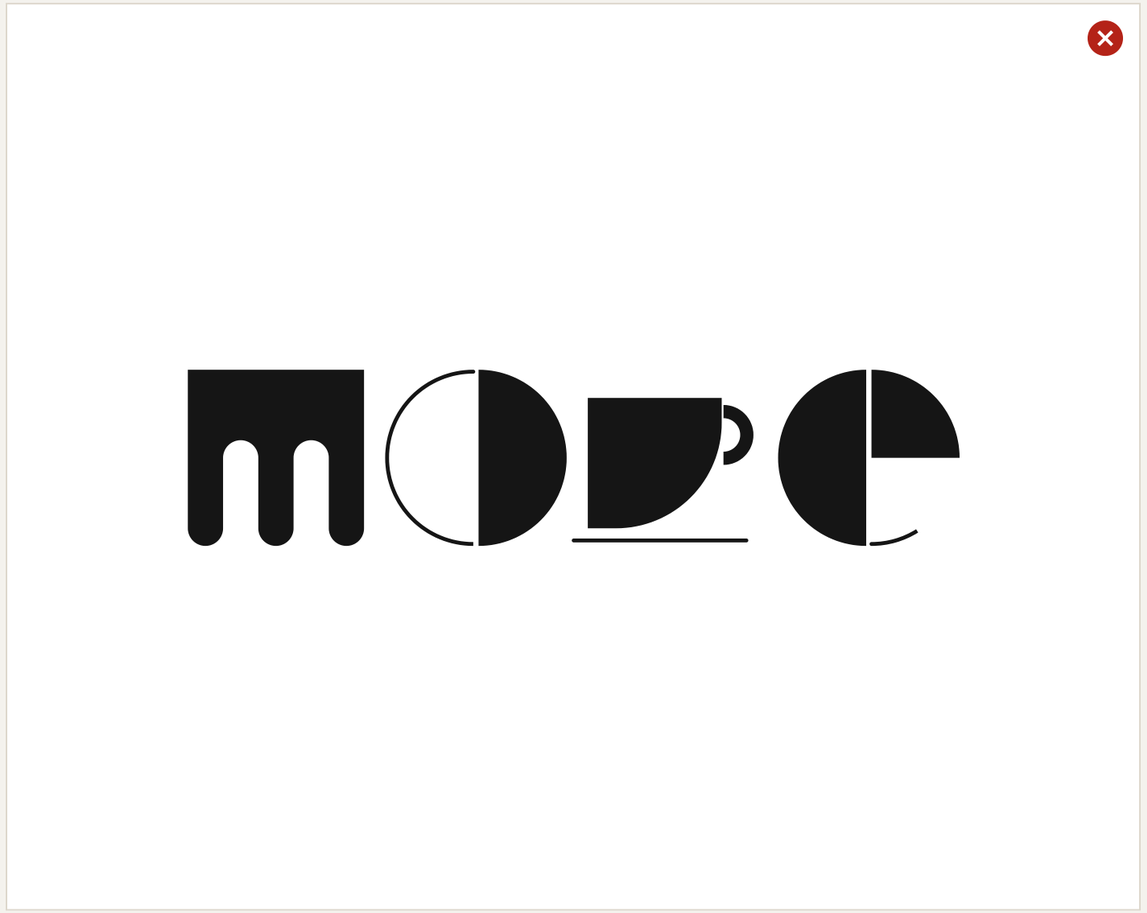
PAPER ON ROAST

PAPER ON GRAPHITE

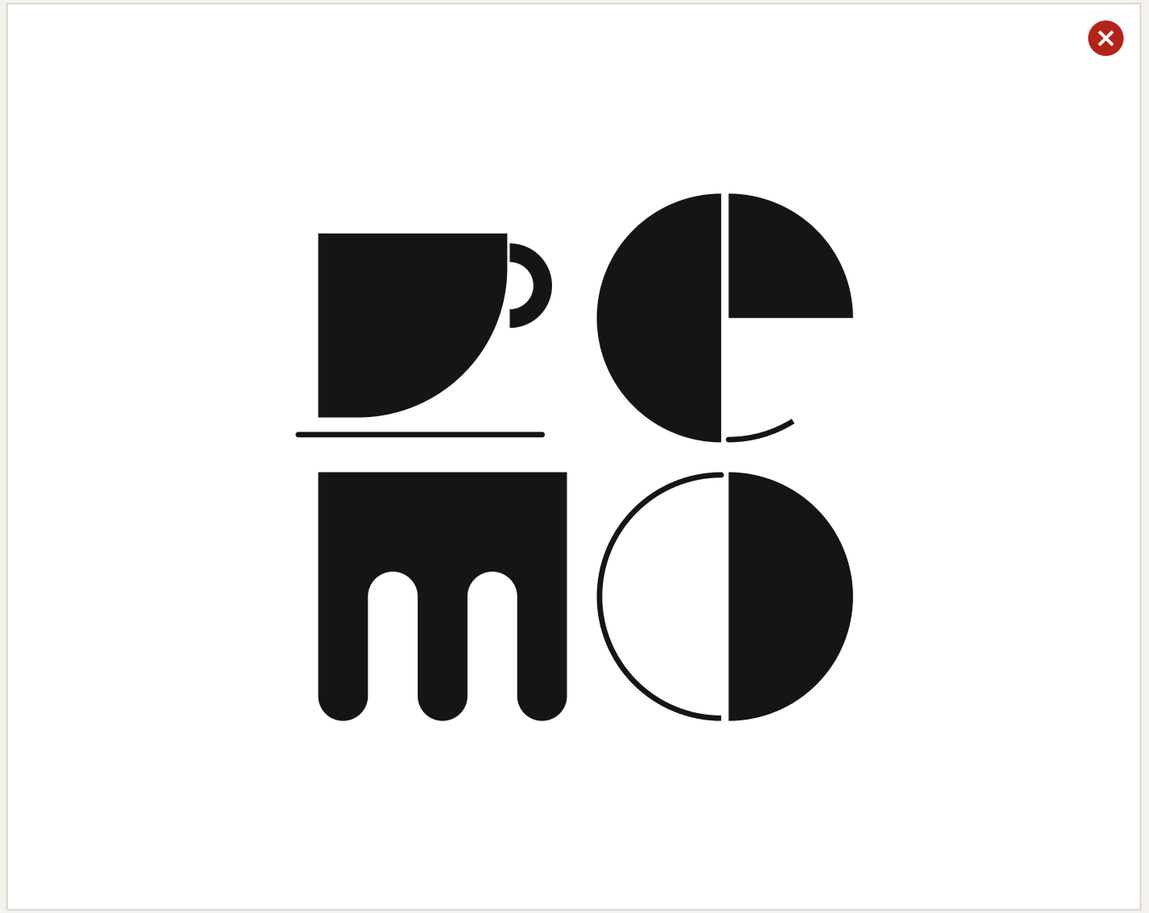
CARBON ON KRAFT, ONE COLOUR

MISUSE

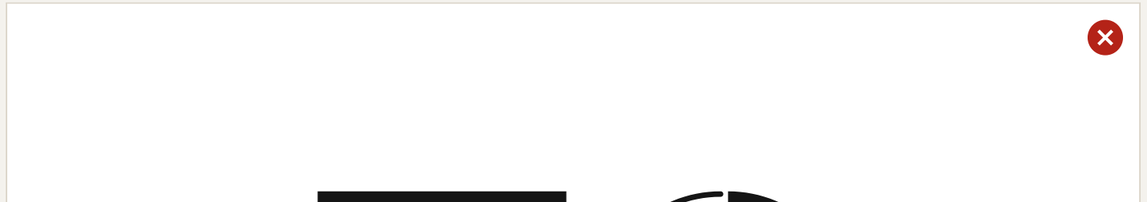
Please don't.

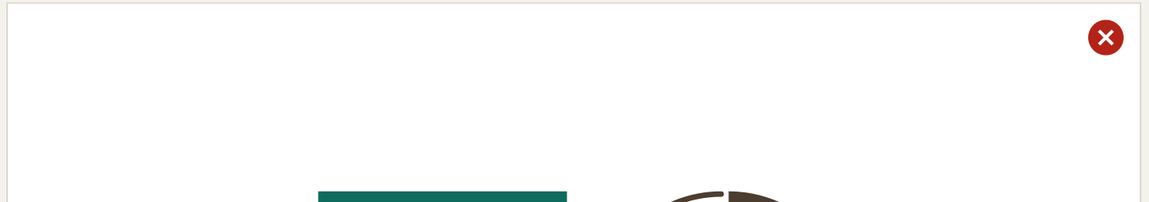


Don't set the letters in a line. MODE is always MO over DE.



Don't rearrange or swap the letters.





COLOUR

Neutrals do the work. Tonic is the one accent.

Carbon

CORE

HEX #151515
RGB 21 21 21
CMYK 0 0 0 95
PMS Neutral Black C

The logo, type, structure

Graphite

CORE

HEX #4A4C4F
RGB 74 76 79
CMYK 0 2 0 80
PMS Cool Gray 11 C

Secondary type, cool grounds

Stone

CORE

HEX #888B8D
RGB 136 139 141
CMYK 2 0 0 52
PMS Cool Gray 8 C

Captions, rules, quiet detail

Silver

White

Paper

CONTRAST

Readable first.

Body text on screen needs 4.5 : 1 (WCAG AA). Large type and the mark need 3 : 1. Stone is for captions and rules on Paper only, never for body text.

	PAIR	RATIO	WCAG
Aa	Carbon on Paper	16.3 : 1	AAA
Aa	Carbon on Oat	13.4 : 1	AAA
Aa	Paper on Roast	9.3 : 1	AAA
Aa	Paper on Graphite	7.7 : 1	AAA
Aa	Paper on Carbon	16.3 : 1	AAA
Aa	Tonic on Paper	5.7 : 1	AA
Aa	White on Tonic	6.4 : 1	AA
Aa	Graphite on Paper	7.7 : 1	AAA
Aa	Stone on Paper	3.1 : 1	AA large

TYPOGRAPHY

Instrument Sans

Aa Bb Cc 0123

Primary. Headlines, product names, body copy. Regular 400, Medium 500, SemiBold 600. Free (SIL Open Font License) on Google Fonts.

IBM Plex Mono

Aa Bb 0123

Secondary. Labels, data, ingredients and the small print on pack, always in capitals with open tracking. Free (SIL OFL).

STYLE	SCREEN	PRINT	SET AS
Display	64–104 / 1.0	24–36 pt	SemiBold, −2% tracking
Headline	40 / 1.05	16–20 pt	SemiBold, −1%
Subhead	24 / 1.25	11 pt	Medium
Body	17 / 1.55	7.5–9 pt	Regular
LABEL	12–14, +14%	5–6 pt, +16%	Plex Mono, capitals
Caption	13 / 1.4	6 pt	Regular, Graphite

One cachet, mandatory text keeps an x-height of at least 0.8 mm (Plex Mono at 5 pt). Check the labelling rules where

THE MODES

One mark. Five modes, named.

The range is the modes. The mark is the same on every pack; the mode is named, never drawn into the letters.

Each mode has four cues: its name, set large; a line that says what it's for; a ground from the palette; and a thin band in its tint across the top, with the name in it. The band is the only place a mode tint appears, so the tints stay well under a tenth of any pack.

Names are always printed, so modes stay apart in one-colour print and for colour-blind customers. A sixth mode needs only a name, a line and a tint.

#SwitchYourMode is the sign-off: written as one word, used on the carton back, the mailer and social.

Lines, notes and caffeine values are placeholders for the brand team to confirm.

	MODE	FOR	BEST AT	TINT
	Wake	For a sharp start.	MORNING	#2771BE · PMS 2727 C
	Active	For the push.	BEFORE EFFORT	#0B8457 · PMS 340 C
	Zen	For deep focus.	DEEP WORK	#4F758B · PMS 5405 C
	Vital	For a midday reset.	MIDDAY	#557F22 · PMS 7490 C
	Calm	For a slow evening.	EVENING	#8C6A4E · PMS 4645 C







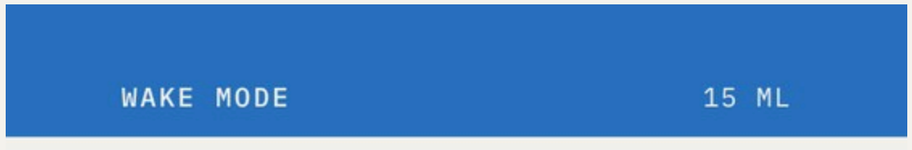
SACHET

60 × 88 mm, a snap line across the middle.

Format	60 × 88 mm finished, heat seal 3.5 mm on all sides, bleed 2 mm
Front	Mode band in its tint · mark 17 mm wide · mode name · its line · the cup, tone on tone
Back	How to (fold, squeeze, pour) · ingredients · per-sachet values · barcode on white · lot and best-before box
Stock	Matte laminate film, reverse printed. Snap line marked by two notches in the seal.
Files	`packaging/sachet/` SVG, PDF with bleed, PNG



ZEN · BACK







SACHET IN USE

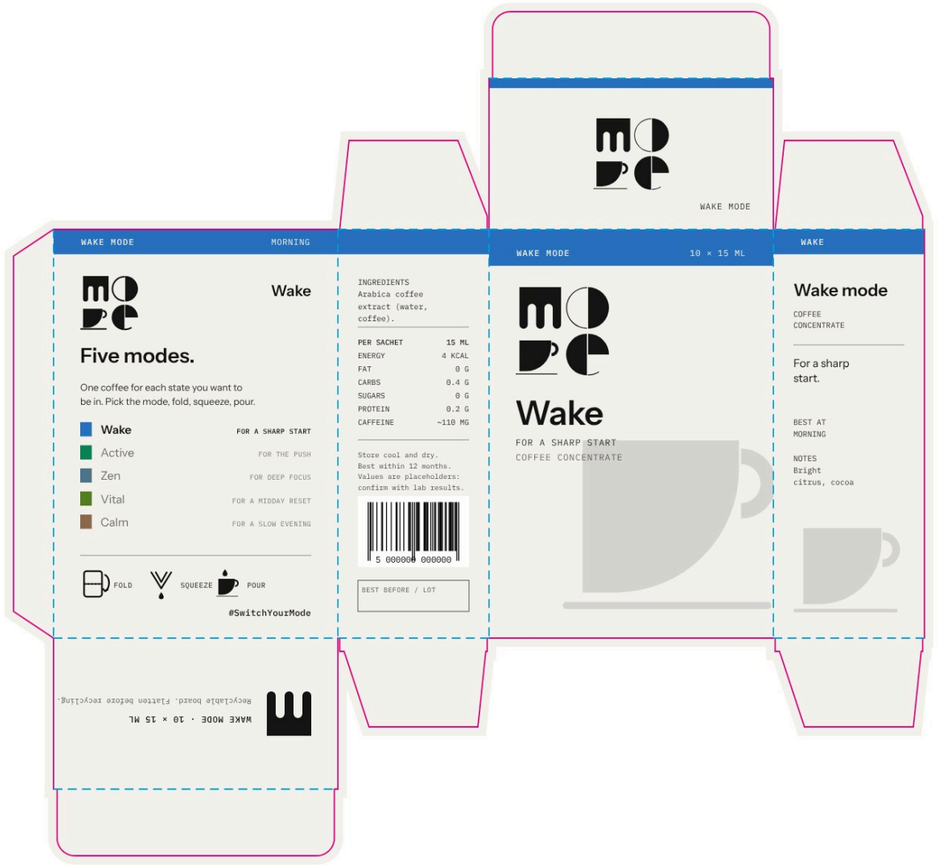
CARTON

Ten sachets, the same system.

Format	64 × 92 × 34 mm, reverse tuck end, 350 gsm GC1 board, matte varnish
Front	Mode band · mark 21 mm · mode name · line · the cup, tone on tone
Back	"Five modes." · all five listed, this one highlighted · how to · #SwitchYourMode
Sides	A: what the mode is for, best time, notes · B: ingredients, nutrition, barcode, lot
Top	Mark centred: the face you see on a shelf from above



CARTON DIELINE



MODE Wake · 10-sachet carton · reverse tuck end · 64 × 92 × 34 mm · art shown from outside

cut — — — fold bleed 2 mm outside the cut · keep text 3 mm inside folds · board 350 gsm GC1

Magenta is the cut, cyan dashed the folds. Bleed 2 mm; keep text 3 mm inside every fold. Confirm the die with the converter before artwork goes final; a blank die is in `packaging/carton/`.

MAILER

The unboxing.

A kraft mailer printed one colour outside (the mark in Carbon, flexo) and flooded Roast inside the lid, so the first thing you see on opening is the four letters and the line that explains them.

Format	220 × 160 × 70 mm, E-flute kraft, holds three cartons
Outside	Mark 64 mm, centred on the lid · one line of Plex Mono
Inside lid	Roast flood · the four letters · "Every letter of MODE is a coffee." · the five modes · #SwitchYourMode





TUMBLER

Carbon powder coat, the mark in Paper at 30 mm, centred on the front. Wrap artwork for a 75 mm tumbler is in `packaging/tumbler/`.



SOCIAL



POST · THE MARK



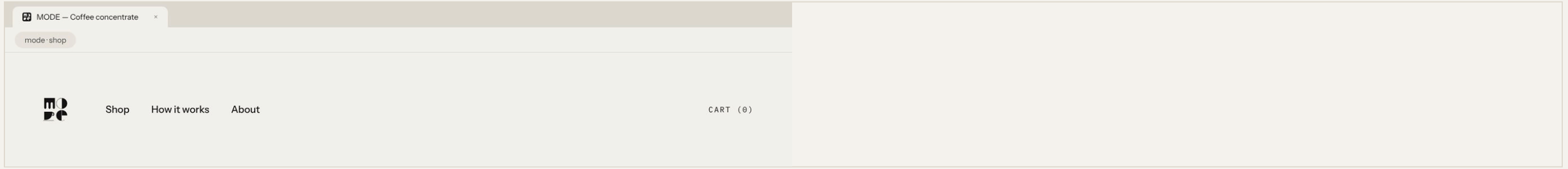
POST · THE MODES





WEB





Tonic is reserved for the one action that matters on a screen (here, Shop the range). Header mark 44–58 px wide.

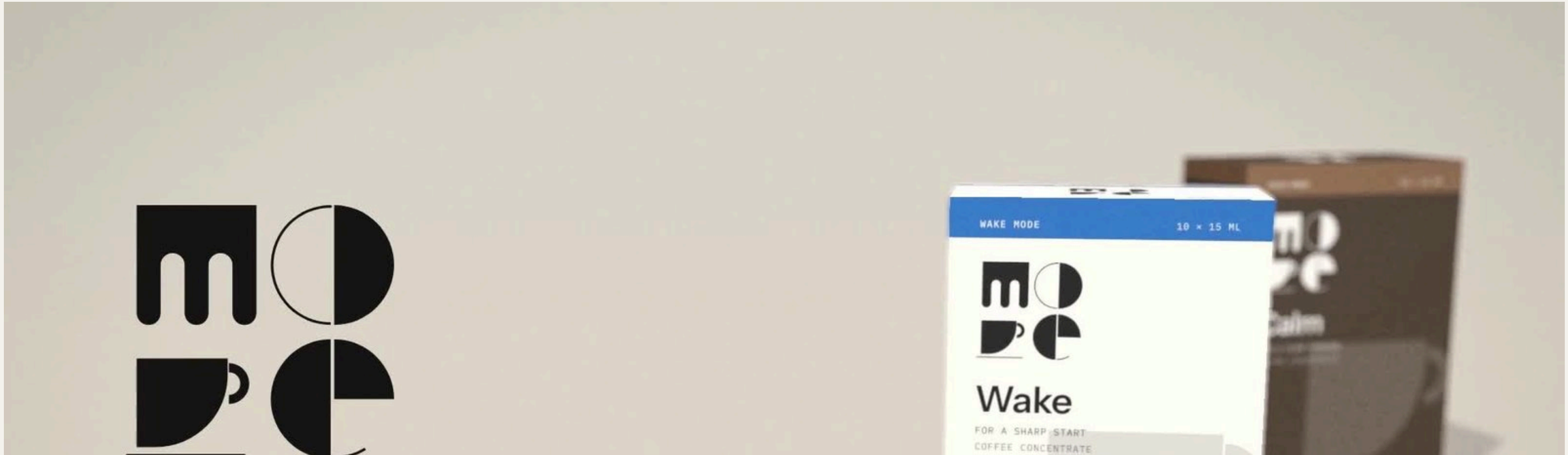
BRAND FILM

From sketch to sachet.

Thirty seconds at 128 BPM. The mark is derived on paper, pencil and compass first and then ink, with a cut on every beat: one radius, one cut, one hairline. Each letter is drawn in turn, the drawing gives way to the five mode colours, and the film finishes on the product with the logo.

The music is an original track made for the film, so it is free to use on YouTube, Instagram and X.

File	`film/out/MODE-Brand-Film.mp4` · 1920 × 1080 · 30 fps · H.264 + AAC · 30 s
Master	`MODE-brand-film-v2-1080p.mp4`, high bitrate, for editing and re-cuts

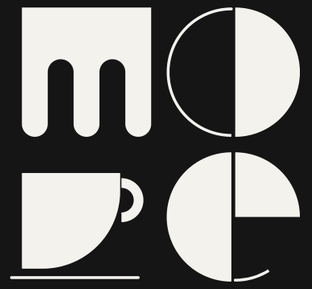


FILES

What's in the kit.

`logo/`	SVG, PDF and PNG (512, 1024, 2048) in Carbon, Paper, Roast, black and white · small-size cut · monogram · with clear space
`icon/`	App icon (1024, 512, 192, 180) · favicon.svg, favicon.ico (16/32/48) · profile pictures
`colour/`	mode-palette.ase (Adobe swatches) · .json · .css custom properties
`packaging/sachet/`	Front and back for all five modes: SVG, print PDF with 2 mm bleed, PNG
`packaging/carton/`	Dielines with artwork for all five modes, plus a blank die: SVG, PDF, PNG
`packaging/mailer/ · tumbler/`	Lid, inside lid and tumbler wrap artwork
`packaging/renders/`	Seven 3D renders, 1800 × 1200
`digital/`	Instagram posts and story, e-commerce tile, website hero and header
`film/out/`	MODE-Brand-Film.mp4 (30 s, 1080p, ready to post) · the high-bitrate master · the music
`fonts/`	Instrument Sans and IBM Plex Mono (SIL Open Font License)
`src/`	The generators. Edit mark.py or brand.py and rebuild: every file regenerates from one source

Masters are SVG and PDF with true arcs and outlined hairlines. They open in Illustrator, Figma and Affinity; save as AI or EPS from there if a printer asks for it. Text in packaging files is live: install the fonts in /fonts first.



MODE · VERSION 1.0 · OCTOBER 2026